SheetForge — Setup Guide

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SheetForge — Setup Guide

What this is

SheetForge adds a set of buttons to your own Excel file. You pick the ones you want on a setup page. You do not write any code.

This guide takes about ten minutes. You do not need to know anything about Excel macros.

The one thing to know first

Read this before you start. It is the part that confuses people.

> To change your settings, click `Finalize Setup Tab`. Then click `Create Setup Tab`. That makes the new questions show up. Answer them. Then click `Finalize Setup Tab` again to save them.

So it is a loop. Pick what you want. Save it. Get asked more. Answer. Save again. You will click `Finalize Setup Tab` twice in the steps below. That is on purpose. It is not a mistake in this guide.

The steps

Do these in order. After each step you will see something new. That is how you know it worked.

1. GET THE FILE

Go to the Releases page. Click the file whose name ends in `.bas`. Click **Download**.

You now have one file. It is the whole toolkit.

2. OPEN YOUR EXCEL FILE

Open the workbook you want the buttons in. Any workbook will do.

Save it as a `.xlsm` file first. Click **File**, then **Save As**, then pick **Excel Macro-Enabled Workbook**. A plain `.xlsx` file cannot hold macros. It will drop them when you close it, and Excel will not warn you.

3. OPEN THE CODE WINDOW

Press `Alt` and `F11` at the same time. A new window opens. It looks nothing like Excel. That is fine. You will only be here for a moment.

4. BRING THE FILE IN

Click **File** in the top left. Click **Import File…**

Find the file you got in step 1. Click it. Click **Open**.

Nothing seems to happen. That is normal.

5. GO BACK TO EXCEL

Press `Alt` and `Q` at the same time. You are back in your workbook.

6. RUN THE FIRST MACRO

Press `Alt` and `F8` at the same time. A small box opens with a list of names.

The list has three names in it:

- `Core_BuildSetup` — makes the setup page. **This is the one you want now.**
- `Core_FinalizeSetup` — saves your answers and builds your buttons. You will do this with a button later, so you do not need it from this list.
- `Core_CompleteSetup` — tidies up at the very end. That is step 12.

Click `Core_BuildSetup`. Click **Run**.

7. FILL IN THE YELLOW BOXES

Two new tabs appear at the bottom of your screen. One is called `Setup`. The other is called `Setup Menu`. You will use both.

Go to the `Setup` tab. Some cells on it are yellow. Yellow means “fill this in”.

Go down the page and fill in the ones you need. You can leave the rest blank for now.

8. PICK YOUR MACROS

Scroll down to the list of macros. Each one has an `Availability` cell next to it. Click that cell and a small arrow appears. Click the arrow to get a list of three choices:

- **Button** — you get a button for it.
- **Chains only** — no button, but you can use it in a chain.
- **Off** — you do not get it.

Every macro starts as **Off**. Pick **Button** for each one you want.

A line of text shows up above the list as soon as you pick your first one. It says:

> Actions are switched on. Click ‘Finalize Setup Tab’ and then ‘Create Setup Tab’ to reveal their option fields.

That is the loop from the top of this page. You are about to do it.

9. SAVE WHAT YOU PICKED

Go to the `Setup Menu` tab. Click `Finalize Setup Tab`.

A box says **Configuration activated**. Click **OK**. You land on a new tab called `Macros Home`.

This step does two jobs. It saves your answers, and it builds your buttons. So if you see that box, it worked.

10. ANSWER THE NEW QUESTIONS

Go back to the `Setup Menu` tab. Click `Create Setup Tab`.

New yellow boxes show up on the `Setup` tab. They are the questions your chosen macros need answered. A macro that saves files will ask where to put them.

Answer them. Then go to `Setup Menu` and click `Finalize Setup Tab` again.

You get the same **Configuration activated** box, and you land on `Macros Home` again. Now your buttons know your answers.

11. USE YOUR BUTTONS

Your buttons are on the `Macros 1` tab. If you picked a lot of them, there will be more tabs: `Macros 2`, and so on.

There is also a tab called `Macros Home`. It lists every macro, what it does, and which tab its button is on. It lists all of them, even the ones you left **Off**. Go there when you forget what something does.

That is it. You are set up. You can stop here.

12. WHEN YOU ARE DONE FOR GOOD

Only do this when your settings are final. It is a one-way step.

Go to the `Setup Menu` tab. Click `Complete Macro Setup`.

This takes away the `Setup`, `Setup Menu` and `Macros Home` tabs. Your buttons stay, and they still work.

It asks you first. Read the box. Press **Enter** and the answer is no, so nothing gets deleted. You have to click **Yes** on purpose.

If you need the setup page back later, press `Alt` and `F8`, then run `Core_BuildSetup` again. Your answers will still be there.

Three small asks

Ask for a macro you want. Open the Issues page and click **New issue**. Write what you wish it did, in plain words. You do not need to know how it would work. That is our job.

Check back now and then. New macros get added. Go to the Releases page, get the newest `.bas` file, and bring it in again the same way you did in step 4. Your answers are kept.

Give it a star if it helped. Go to the project page and click the **Star** button near the top right. It is free, and it helps other people find this.